

Curriculum Vitae

DR. MAHENDRA SONI

MBBS, MD (Community Medicine)

Surveillance Medical Officer (SMO) - WHO

National Polio Surveillance Network (NPSN)

Office add. : WHO office at Pandit deen dayal hospital, Pandeypur, Varanasi, UP

Permanent add. : Gautum marg, Ujjain, MP

Contact no. 7999899363, 9713632399

Mail ID : mahendra3632399@gmail.com

Ex SMO : Dist. Maharajganj & Kushinagar, UP



✚ EDUCATION :

➤ Master Degree -

- M.D. (Doctor of Medicine)
- Department - Community Medicine
- Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose Medical College, Jabalpur (M.P.),
- Admission batch 2020

➤ Bachelor Degree -

- M.B.B.S. (Bachelor of Medicine, Bachelor of Surgery)
- R.D. Gardi Medical College, Ujjain (M.P.),
- Admission batch 2009

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY WITH EXPERIENCE :

➤ **Nature of Work** -

- Planning, Capacity building, Supportive supervision, Surveillance / Monitoring, Evaluation, Analysis of trends, and Feedback meetings

➤ **Description** -

- The role involves providing technical guidance and building the capacity of government and non-government staff to sustain a polio-free status in alignment with the Polio Eradication and Endgame Strategic Plan. It includes facilitating activities related to AFP surveillance, supplementary polio immunization, routine immunization strengthening, and outbreak response to wild, vaccine-derived, or Sabin-like type 2 polioviruses while ensuring a smooth transition to broader public health priorities. Additionally, it supports the intensification of routine immunization, measles elimination, rubella control, and surveillance of vaccine-preventable diseases (VPDs) with strong focus on strengthening vaccine-preventable disease surveillance and outbreak response in collaboration with the Integrated Disease Surveillance Programme (IDSP). The role requires close coordination with partner agencies, non-governmental organizations, and professional bodies, along with regular epidemiological analysis and interpretation of surveillance and immunization data to guide evidence-based actions at district and state levels. I also have role in monitoring vaccination services at nine Indo–Nepal international border booths in Maharajganj. I am also monitoring and supporting key public health initiatives, including the “Sanchari Dastak Abhiyaan” for controlling communicable diseases such as TB and JE/AES; the “Swasth Nari Sashakt Parivar Abhiyaan,” a GOI initiative under Poshan

Maah 2025 aimed at improving the health and nutrition of women, adolescent girls, and children; and the “Teeka Utsav” (December 2025–January 2026), which focuses on routine immunization of children and pregnant women. In addition, I cross-check and monitor “BeSD (Behavioral & Social Drivers) surveys” among zero-dose and partially vaccinated children in selected high-priority districts of India, utilizing the “Track Vac” digital platform to identify missed and zero-dose (unvaccinated) children, and participate in “High-Risk Area (HRA) validation” to map and reach underserved and migrant populations for equitable immunization coverage. I am also involved in monitoring the “WHO Cluster Survey” for estimation of Pentavalent-1 coverage to deduce zero-dose prevalence. Furthermore, I am engaged in the “assessment of a proposed Hub & Spoke Institute for Routine Immunization (RI) training in India”, which is based on a tiered capacity-building framework under the Health System Strengthening (HSS-3) initiative of the Immunization Technical Support Unit (ITSU). Additionally, I have been involved in “PSA mock drills-8” recommended by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW), to ensure functionality and operational readiness of medical oxygen supply through Pressure Swing Adsorption (PSA) plants during potential exigencies. The role also involves preparing presentations, reports, and strategic documents to support decision-making and implementation at district and state levels. Furthermore, it contributes to implementing health priorities, including Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), as part of WHO’s Country Cooperation Strategy. In addition, the role has involved facilitating the conversion of vaccine-resistant communities into vaccine-accepting populations through targeted advocacy and strategic engagement, while also advocating for administrative support in field monitoring and conducting joint assessments with the District Magistrate

(DM), Chief Development Officer (CDO), Chief Medical Officer (CMO), District Surveillance Officer (DSO) and District Immunization Officer (DIO). I have also conducted training sessions & workshops for trainers, including Medical Officers In-Charge (MOICs), Medical Officers (MOs), Block Programme Manager (BPM) and Laboratory Technicians (LTs) on sensitive topics such as Adverse Events Following Immunization (AEFI), Routine Immunization Microplanning & Vaccine Preventable Diseases (VPDs) Surveillance in collaboration with the Additional Chief Medical Officer (ACMO) and District Immunization Officer (DIO).

➤ **Work experience -**

- I am Dr. Mahendra Soni, I hold a postgraduate degree in Community Medicine, which has further strengthened my expertise in public health. Currently working as a Surveillance Medical Officer at the WHO Unit in Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh. Previously I was the SMO of district Maharajganj & Kushinagar, Uttar Pradesh. I also had role in monitoring vaccination services at nine “Indo–Nepal international border booths” in district Maharajganj. I am Having experience of more than 07 years including Public Health (NRC Medical Officer, Post-graduation, Senior Residency & WHO) as well as General Physician (After MBBS). Now, I have developed a comprehensive skill set and gained extensive experience in the realm of immunization, vaccine preventable diseases surveillance, mobilization of Vaccine Avoidance Behavior (VAB) families, and effective response to different health programs. In my current role, I lead actions in a high-priority Gavi-supported district, providing substantial leadership and support to the WHO-NPSP. Currently, I have a diverse team of 30 professional members across the district, focusing on strengthening routine immunization, VPD surveillance,

microplanning, HRA validation, Head Count validation, and capacity building of healthcare workers ranging from ASHA workers to district-level officials. Additionally, I actively contribute insights and recommendations to enhance health outcomes in these regions. “During this period, I had the opportunity to lead the complete transition and smooth closure of Kushinagar & Maharajganj WHO NPSN unit. I dedicated myself fully to ensuring a smooth and successful transition process”. After transitioning of Maharajganj unit, I relocated to district Varanasi as SMO. In district Varanasi, Sewage sample collected from two pumping stations to insure Environmental Surveillance for poliovirus. From 1st day of my joining, I got engaged in epidemiological investigations of Vaccine derived poliovirus type 3 (VDPV3) with 13 nucleotides because unfortunately It was found in sewage sampling that time. During these 10 days investigations with 90 days follow-up activity, I got opportunity to work with State and National Surveillance team. During this activity I got opportunity to work on Multiple pathogen for Wastewater surveillance. Even I have involved in National Immunization Day (NID) for the Pulse Polio Programme, scheduled every year. During this nationwide drive, children under the age of 5 years will receive supplementary oral polio drops (OPV) to maintain the country's polio-free status. The activity includes multiple meetings, proper planning, human resource for booth vaccination, house to house vaccination, house to house monitoring, supervision of vaccinators & monitors, data analysis & feedback sharing meeting with DM, CMO, DIO, SDM, even with MOICs.

- During senior residency and postgraduation, I guided undergraduate students on Communicable & Non-communicable diseases, RMNCAH (reproductive, maternal, newborn, child, and adolescent health), Mental health,

Immunization Conducting community health surveys under family adaptation programme (FAP) and facilitated their involvement in public health awareness campaigns during multispecialty health camps. I organized the 2024 World Health Day Quiz Competition to promote health education and awareness among undergraduate students. Also involved in Teaching & Training of undergraduate & postgraduate students, delivering Preventive, Promotive & Curative healthcare services to the community, & working towards the improvement and development of Rural Health & Training Centre (RHTC), Departmental Museum & Skill Lab.

- While during post-graduation, I was entrusted with key pandemic-related responsibilities, including managing duties in COVID-19 wards, COVID Care Centers, Fever Clinic, Health Information & Management System (HIMS), COVID death management, COVID vaccination, and the Mucormycosis (Black Fungus) ward. Additionally, I carried out field activities related to HIV Sentinel Surveillance, Sub-National Certification (SNC) for TB elimination verification, Routine Immunization Supportive Supervision (RISS), Sero-Surveillance, Community Diagnosis, and Maternal Death Surveillance & Response (MDSR). I collaborated with colleagues to organize a Continuing Medical Education (CME) program as part of my postgraduate training. I also presented seminars and guided undergraduate students.
- After my under-graduation (MBBS), I worked as a Medical Officer at Ujjain Charitable Trust Hospital & Research Centre, Ujjain. Initially, I managed the Male and Female General wards. Additionally, I managed casualty and MICU in the absence of assigned doctors. I provided training and supervision to my staff, and I personally performed various minor and major procedures, such

as incision and drainage, dressing of HIV and Hepatitis patients, pleural and ascitic tapping, lumbar puncture, and catheterization etc. Prior to all procedures, I ensured to counsel my patients. Furthermore, I supervised my staff during the execution of any procedures.

- After getting clinical experience of 2 years, I joined as NRC-MO at District Hospital, Agar Malwa, after successfully clearing an interview with the National Health Mission in Bhopal. At the district hospital, I was responsible for managing the NRC while also conducting regular field visits to supervise and oversee the operations of two additional block NRCs. But when COVID arrived, my duties were redirected to the COVID ward, where I was assigned for managing and treating suspected and confirmed cases, as well as overseeing related logistics. Subsequently, I was selected for post-graduation in the department of community medicine at N.S.C.B. Medical College, Jabalpur (M.P.)

SKILLS :

- Disease Surveillance
- Outbreak Investigation
- Program Planning & Implementation
- Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E)
- Epidemiology & Biostatistics
- Data Analysis (SPSS, Excel)
- Work on portals like VSIMS, iMAS, Track Vac, Safe Vac
- Health Communication
- Team work

CAPACITY BUILDING & TRAINING :

- Health Systems Strengthening
- Policy Advocacy
- Report Writing
- Presentation via MS Office
- Training of Trainers

ACHIEVEMENTS :

- Successfully completed the 06-month Certificate Course in **“Artificial Intelligence in Healthcare”** conducted by the **National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences (NBEMS), Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Government of India**, achieving an overall score of 96%. Also honored to have the Guinness World Record™ title for the “Most viewers of an Artificial Intelligence in Healthcare lesson livestream on YouTube” on 25 February 2026.
- Got once in a lifetime experience of **“Epidemiological Investigations after detection of Vaccine Derived Polio Virus type 3 (VDPV 3) with 13 nucleotides during Environmental surveillance (Sewage sampling)”**.
- **Presenter** at “State Level Sensitization Cum Consultation Meeting focus on Strengthening Immunization Data Systems and Review Mechanisms at Varanasi, U.P”.
- Completed the **“Introductory Certificate Course of Mathematical Modelling for control of infectious diseases in India by NIHFWS & ICMR**

NITVAR”.

- Successfully completed **“eCourse on Non-Communicable Diseases”** with grade A+, awarded by the **Public Health Foundation of India (pfhi)**.
- Actively contributed to the Divisional Meeting on 2025 performance feedback, chaired by the AD, Medical & Health Services, Lucknow, conducted in January 2026 at the CMO Office, Maharajganj.
- Participated in an International **“Cross-border capacity building meeting for SMOs from India and Nepal at Gorakhpur, India”**
- Successfully completed ArcView GIS training conducted by the World Health Organization, enhancing skills in spatial data analysis and mapping.
- Participated in “State level Training of Trainers on Health Worker (HW) Manual 2025 for Routine Immunization”, organized by World Health Organization in Lucknow.
- Certificate of successfully completing the **IDF** Online Short course on **“PREVENTION OF TYPE 2 DIABETES”**
- Certificate of achievement of an “Interventions for Non-Communicable Diseases in Primary Health Care” & “HEARTS of NCD: An integrated approach to management of noncommunicable diseases (NCD) in primary health care” both courses developed by the WHO Regional Office for South-East Asia offered on OpenWHO.
- “Experience certificates” of Senior residency from RD Gardi Medical College, Ujjain & Post graduation from NSCB Medical College, Jabalpur.
- Participated as a ‘Delegate’ in the National webinar on “Lesson learnt from

emerging infectious diseases. What's next ?" Department of Community medicine of Jawaharlal Nehru Medical College, Belagavi

- **"Mixed Method Research"** by Gandhi Medical College, Bhopal & IAPSM in collaboration with All India Institute of Hygiene & Public Health, Kolkata
- "Non-Alcoholic Fatty Liver Disease (NAFLD): An emerging epidemic of non-communicable disease in India" by Institute of Liver and Biliary Sciences, New Delhi and All India Institute of Medical Sciences, AIIMS Mangalagiri, Andhra Pradesh
- Completed "One Week Online Training Programme on Statistical Data Analysis Using SPSS Software" organized by Science Tech Institute
- "Complacency with COVID-19 Pandemic in India" by National Institute of public health training & research, Mumbai
- Got 75% in "Basic Course in Biomedical Research" as mandated by National Medical Commission.
- Got Silver medal in "Basic of Health Promotion and Education Intervention", conducted by NPTEL & funded by MoE, Govt. of India.
- Got Gold medal in "**Maternal Infant Young Child Nutrition**", conducted by NPTEL & funded by MoE, Govt. of India.
- Certification of working experience as NRC Medical Officer, District hospital, Agar Malwa, Madhya Pradesh.

COMPUTER SKILLS :

➤ **Knowledge of -**

- MS Word (Advance knowledge)
- MS Excel (Advance knowledge)
- MS PowerPoint (Advance knowledge)
- SPSS Statistical analysis software (Advance knowledge)
- ArcView GIS for mapping (Basic knowledge)
- Communication tools (Zoom, MS Team & Google Meet)

These skills help me to work with information, communicate, analyze data, and solve problems using technology. Now a days, I am trying to analyze my data by using AI tools (Microsoft with AI).

PUBLICATIONS :

- Predictors of High-risk Pregnancy at One of the Tertiary Care Centers of Jabalpur, Madhya Pradesh: A cross-sectional study. In Healthline Journal
- Impact of COVID-19 pandemic on routine immunization of under 5 children in Jabalpur district of Madhya Pradesh. A descriptive cross-sectional study. In Global journal of medicine and public health

LANGUAGE :

- English
- Hindi (Mother tongue)